



Department of Telecommunications  
Telecommunication Engineering Centre  
K. L. Bhawan, Janpath, New Delhi – 110001  
(Convergence & Broadcasting Division)



No: 4-16/2018-C&B/TEC/NWG-9

Dated: 28 July 2023

**Sub: Minutes of the 9th Meeting of National Working Group-9 (NWG-9) regarding "Broadband Cable and TV" held on 19.07.2023.**

The 9<sup>th</sup> meeting of the National Working Group-9 (NWG-9) corresponding to the ITU-T Study Group 9 (SG9) constituted for the Study Period 2022-24 regarding "Broadband Cable and TV" was held on 19.07.2023 under the chairmanship of Sh. Avinash Agarwal, DDG (Convergence & Broadcasting), TEC through video-conferencing. List of participants is placed at Annexure-I.

2. Sh. Harsh Sharma, Convener NWG-9 & Director (C&B) TEC, welcomed all participants and provided a summary of the previous meeting held on 13th April 2023. He highlighted India's successful organisation of the ITU-T Study Group 9 (SG-9) meeting at IISc Bangalore from 9th to 18th May 2023, jointly hosted by TEC/DoT and IISc Bangalore. Seven Indian contributions were discussed during the meeting, which also featured a hybrid ITU Workshop on "The Future of Television for South Asia, Arab, and Africa Regions" on 11th May 2023, attended by over 200 participants from 50 countries.

3. Shri Avinash Agarwal, Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B) TEC, noted that this was the first physical meeting of SG9 during the current Study Period (2022-2024) and the first time India hosted the SG9 meeting. Delegates and representatives from various countries attended in physical and remote modes, along with ITU and other experts. The Indian delegation actively participated and contributed to most questions, with members taking on roles as Vice-Chairs, Rapporteurs, and Associate Rapporteurs in multiple sessions. The event received praise from the telecom, broadcasting sector, foreign delegates, and the ITU-T management team. Dr. Satoshi Miyaji, Chairman of ITU-T SG9, also appreciated the hosting by India, during the TSAG meeting.

Looking ahead, the next ITU-T SG-9 meeting is scheduled for Nov-Dec 2023, with RGM meetings between July and September. The Chairman encouraged collaboration to prepare contributions on new and ongoing work items.

He proposed forming National Working Parties (NWP) under each NWG to enhance stakeholder involvement from industry, academia, and R&D institutions in ITU

standardization activities. These NWP, led by members from diverse domains, will coordinate specific technical work under NWG-9.

He also sought suggestions from participants to address the issue of poor member participation in the NWG-9 meetings.

4. This was followed by the open house discussion, as detailed below:

**(A) New contributions/ work items received from members before the NWG-9 meeting**

*No New Contribution received.*

**(B) Draft potential contributions on the ongoing work items of ITU-T SG9**

Sh. P. C. Jain, Member NWG-9 submitted inputs on two ongoing work items, namely Q1/9 'J.TR.WiFiTV (Technical Report) and Q6/9 revision in existing recommendation ITU-T J.298. After deliberation, NWG-9 requested him to examine the scope of the existing work items, and also to discuss the inputs with the Editors of these work items, i.e. Sh. Pallab Dutta, C-DoT Bangalore and Ms. Meenakshi Singhvi, Director, Prasar Bharti Mumbai.

**(C) Participation of academic and research institutes in NWG-9**

Shri Avinash Agarwal, Chairman NWG-9 observed with concern that the level of participation from academia in NWG-9 meetings fell short of expectations. He urged all members to identify and nominate relevant experts, including subject experts from academia and practitioners, to join NWG-9. Some members suggested handling these nominations separately with the respective contributors.

**(D) Involvement of start-ups and other industries (related to telecom field) in the ITU-T processes.**

In order to foster greater involvement from start-ups, the Chairman of NWG-9 encouraged members to provide their views and inputs via email.

**(E) Use of Standards Coordination Portal.**

Sh. Harsh Sharma, Convener NWG-9 & Director (C&B) TEC informed that Secretary (Telecom) has recently launched the Standards Coordination Portal (SCP) during the "National Workshop on Enhancing Indian Participation in Telecom Global Standards Bodies" conducted by TEC on 07.07.2023. The portal facilitates Indian contributions to different Global Standardization Organizations and Standards Development Organizations (SDOs).

The registered members and contributors can access information about all National Groups through this portal. They can also upload and revise their contributions and view/download contributions from other members. They can also access the relevant ITU-T documents even if they do not have the TIES account, required for accessing documents from ITU website. Standards Coordination portal of TEC will be a good repository of work for Indian contributions. All NWG-9 members were requested to register at SCP portal ([www.tec.gov.in/scp](http://www.tec.gov.in/scp)) immediately and start using it for all related activities.

**(F) Formation of NWP for NWG-9**

Participants were requested to volunteer for the Chair and Vice-chair positions of the proposed National Working Parties under the NWG-9. Chairman NWG-9 conveyed that the NWPs may be led by members from industries, start-ups, academia, and researchers. All members agreed to constitute two NWPs corresponding to the two Working Parties of the SG9. Further, after discussion, NWG-9 recommended following members to lead the two NWPs under NWG-9:

|                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                |                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| SG-9 WP 1/9:<br>Cable transport and terminals, including video and data | <b>NWP 1/9:</b><br><b>Chairman:</b> Sh. Pallab Dutta, C-DoT<br><b>Vice Chairman:</b> Sh. Rajeev Khattar, Industry Expert & Reacher             | Questions<br><br>(Q1, Q2, Q4, Q6, Q7)  |
| SG-9 WP 2/9:<br>Cable-related platforms and applications                | <b>NWP 2/9:</b><br><b>Chairman:</b> Ms. Meenakshi Singhvi, Prasar Bharti<br><b>Vice Chairman:</b> Sh. Ramesh DS, M/s Exalto Communication Ltd. | Questions<br><br>(Q3, Q5, Q8, Q9, Q11) |

5. Sh. Paritosh Saha from Disney-Hotstar stated that he had been involved in some contributions presented during the SG-9 meeting and expressed his commitment to carry them forward in the ongoing work items. He also proposed to submit a new contribution on 'IoT in Setup box' and other related topics in the Broadcasting Sector. At the request of other members, he provided a detailed explanation of the use of IoT in both the Broadcasting sector and home gateway. The Chair encouraged him to involve more people in NWG-9.

6. Sh. Ramesh DS, representing M/s Exalto, shared his feedback regarding the experience of the previous SG-9 meeting held in Bangalore. He expressed his willingness to contribute on various topics related to NWG-9 and also informed the attendees about different products during the meeting.

7. Ms. Meenakshi Singhvi from Prasar Bharti suggested that the preparation of contributions should focus on various topics such as the application of AI or IoT in the Setup box and home automation. These topics could either be included in existing documents or initiated as new ones.

8. Shri Avinash Agarwal raised concerns about the irregular attendance of several members in NWG-9 meetings. He requested all members to provide ideas or suggestions to improve active participation. After thorough discussion, it was decided that, similar to BIS

(Bureau of Indian Standards), an attendance sheet will be circulated, showing the attendance record of previous meetings. To maintain active membership, it was agreed to set a minimum attendance criterion of attending at least 4 meetings for NWG-9. Members failing to meet this criterion may be removed from NWG-9.

9. Lastly, the meeting concluded with a vote of thanks to the Chair for presiding over the session.



**(Harsh Sharma)**

Convener, NWG-9 & Director, (C&B), TEC

**Encl.: Annexure-I**

To,

All members of the NWG-9 and all the Participants.

Copy for kind information to:

1. Advisor & Head TEC, New Delhi
2. Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B), TEC, New Delhi.

## **ANNEXURE-I**

### **List of Participants:**

1. Sh. Avinash Agarwal, Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B), TEC.
2. Ms. Meenakshi Singhvi, Director, AIR & Doordarshan, Prasar Bharti Mumbai
3. Sh. A. K. Mittal, Advisor TSDSI
4. Sh. Shubhanshu Gupta, C-DAC
5. Sh. Rajiv Khattar, Researcher & Industry specialist
6. Sh. Paritosh Saha, Disney-Hotstar
7. Sh. Shubhash Kumar
8. Sh. Ramesh DS, M/s Exalto Communication Ltd.Dr.
9. Sh. Sunil Shenoy, M/s Sunren Mumbai
10. Sh. M. Rajendran
11. Dr. Prem Chand Jain, Professor (Guest), Shiv Nadar University
12. Sh. Rakesh Desai, DDG(FA), TEC
13. Sh. Naveen Khichar, ADET DoT
14. Sh. Harsh Sharma, Convener, NWG-9 & Director (C&B), TEC.

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